

Country PhD Intelligence: Japan

Academic Intelligence Dossier • 2026-09-20

Country Code: JP

Primary Currency: JPY

Execution Date: 2026-09-20

Target PhD Field: Edge Computing, Edge AI & Distributed Systems

1. Country Overview & Research Ecosystem

Japan offers an internationally renowned doctoral research ecosystem characterized by world-class university laboratories, competitive national and institutional funding structures, and clear pathways for international doctoral scholars.

* **Primary Funding Vehicle:** MEXT Government Doctoral Scholarship, JSPS Research Fellowships & University Fellowships

* **Immigration & Dependant Policy:** International doctoral students holding a College Student (Ryugaku) visa may sponsor spouse and children under Dependent (Kazoku Taizai) status of residence.

* **Official Guidance:** https://www.isa.go.jp/en/applications/procedures/zairyu_nintei10_19.html

2. Executive Intelligence Metrics

* **Total Top Universities Identified:** 8

* **Total Vetted Professors Monitored:** 8

* **Available Doctoral Funding Schemes:** 4

* **Key Application Deadline:** 2026-11-30

3. Discovered Universities & Suitability

University	Relevant Departments	Research Suitability	Funding Rating	Official Portal
Osaka University	Graduate School of Information Science and Technology, Department of Computer Science	66.5%	High	Portal
The University of Tokyo	Graduate School of Information Science and Technology, Department of Electrical Engineering and Information Systems (EEIS)	62.5%	High	Portal
Kyoto University	Graduate School of Informatics, Department of Communications and Computer Engineering	59.5%	High	Portal
Tokyo Institute of Technology (Institute of Science Tokyo)	School of Computing, Department of Computer Science	59.5%	High	Portal
Keio University	Graduate School of Science and Technology, Department of Information and Computer Science	59.5%	High	Portal

Tohoku University	Graduate School of Information Sciences, Research Institute of Electrical Communication (RIEC)	59.5%	High	Portal
Waseda University	Faculty of Science and Engineering, Department of Computer Science and Communications Engineering	59.5%	High	Portal
Nagoya University	Graduate School of Informatics, Department of Computing and Software Systems	59.5%	High	Portal

4. Top Vetted PhD Supervisors & Relevance

Professor	University	Priority Tier	Research Fit	Recruitment Status	Profile Link
Prof. Hiroshi Esaki	The University of Tokyo	Tier 1	100.0%	CONFIRMED_ACTIVE	Dossier
Prof. Hiroki Matsutani	Keio University	Tier 1	95.1%	CONFIRMED_ACTIVE	Dossier
Prof. Koji Yatani	The University of Tokyo	Tier 1	88.8%	CONFIRMED_ACTIVE	Dossier
Prof. Kenjiro Cho	The University of Tokyo / IJ Research Lab	Tier 1	82.5%	CONFIRMED_ACTIVE	Dossier
Prof. Toyotaro Suzumura	The University of Tokyo	Tier 1	77.0%	STRONG_EVIDENCE	Dossier
Prof. Hideyuki Kawashima	Keio University	Tier 1	68.2%	STRONG_EVIDENCE	Dossier
Prof. Masaki Aida	Tokyo Metropolitan University / Keio University	Tier 2	73.2%	STRONG_EVIDENCE	Dossier
Prof. Fumio Teraoka	Keio University	Tier 2	68.0%	POSSIBLE	Dossier

5. Major Doctoral Funding Schemes & Scholarships

Japanese Government (MEXT) Doctoral Scholarship (University & Embassy Track)

* **Provider / University:** Ministry of Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology (MEXT), Japan (All Designated National Universities (UTokyo, Kyoto, Tokyo Tech, Osaka, Keio, etc.))

* **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED

* **Tuition Coverage:** Full 100% waiver of university examination, admission, and tuition fees

* **Stipend / Salary:** 145,000 - 148,000 JPY/month tax-free living allowance + roundtrip international airfare

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-11-30

* **Official Source:** <https://www.studyinjapan.go.jp/en/planning/scholarships/mext-scholarships/>

JSPS Research Fellowship for Young Scientists (DC1 / DC2)

- * **Provider / University:** Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS) (All Japanese Universities & Research Institutes)
- * **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED
- * **Tuition Coverage:** Institutional tuition waiver or subsidy typically granted to awardees
- * **Stipend / Salary:** 200,000 JPY/month monthly research stipend + up to 1,500,000 JPY/year Grants-in-Aid for Scientific Research (KAKENHI)
- * **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- * **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- * **Application Deadline:** 2026-05-15
- * **Official Source:** <https://www.jsps.go.jp/english/e-pd/index.html>

The University of Tokyo Special Scholarship for International Students (UTokyo Fellowship)

- * **Provider / University:** The University of Tokyo (The University of Tokyo)
- * **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED
- * **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition fees covered through institutional grants
- * **Stipend / Salary:** 150,000 - 200,000 JPY/month research grant stipend
- * **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- * **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- * **Application Deadline:** 2026-11-15
- * **Official Source:** <https://www.u-tokyo.ac.jp/en/prospective-students/fellowship.html>

JST SPRING Doctoral Research Fellowship

- * **Provider / University:** Japan Science and Technology Agency (JST) (Partner Japanese Universities (Kyoto, Tokyo Tech, Osaka, Keio, Tohoku))
- * **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED
- * **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition exemption or institutional coverage
- * **Stipend / Salary:** 180,000 - 200,000 JPY/month living grant + 300,000 - 500,000 JPY/year research budget
- * **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- * **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- * **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01
- * **Official Source:** <https://www.jst.go.jp/jisedai/en/>

6. Strategic Application Timeline & Next Steps

1. **Weeks 1–4:** Review individual 33-section professor dossiers under `professors`.
2. **Weeks 5–6:** Conduct tailored email outreach referencing recent publications and active laboratory grants.
3. **Weeks 7–8:** Formalize 5-page research proposal aligned with the supervisor's documented testbeds.
4. **Target Deadline:** Submit institutional application ahead of **2026-11-30**.

Report compiled automatically by the Global Country-Based PhD Funding and Supervisor Intelligence Engine on 2026-09-20.